

FREE GUIDE

Too Many **Hats**, Not Enough Hours

How small businesses are getting time back
without adding headcount.

Logan Shimmer

Shimmer Labs

shimmerlabs.co

THE PROBLEM

You're Using a **Ferrari** as a Go-Kart

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WHAT MOST PEOPLE DO

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WHAT'S ACTUALLY POSSIBLE

An assistant that works for you 24/7. No prompting required.

Monitors your business, drafts outreach, flags problems before you wake up.

The gap between what these tools **can do** and what people **make them do** is enormous.

The Numbers Don't Lie

74%

of companies report **no tangible value** from these tools yet

McKinsey 2026

5%

of Fortune 500 got past the **pilot stage** with Copilot

Microsoft internal data

84%

of companies have **not redesigned** jobs around automation

Deloitte 2026

The problem isn't the technology. It's **how we're using it.**

THE REAL PROBLEM

You Didn't Start Your Business to Do Bookkeeping

But here you are, wearing every hat.

Sales

Accounting

Marketing

IT Support

HR

Operations

Customer Support

Invoicing

Lead Qualification

Social Media

Scheduling

Data Entry



You got into this because you're **great at the thing**



Every extra hat is time **away from why you started**



Hiring help means **payroll before you're ready**



What if you could hand some hats off — **without the headcount?**

Which hats fit best on **your assistant?**

Here's the thing most people miss: you don't need to hire someone for every hat. You don't even need to learn a new tool for every hat. What you need is a way to hand off the repetitive, time-draining work that doesn't actually require *you* — the specific, irreplaceable you — to get done.

That's not a fantasy. Businesses of all sizes are already doing this. Not with expensive enterprise software. Not with a team of developers. With the same tools you probably already have access to — just used very differently than most people realize.

The next few pages will show you exactly how. We'll cover three key shifts in how people work with these tools, what an "agent" actually is (spoiler: it's simpler than you think), and a concrete plan you can start today — even if you've never touched any of this before.

From Chatbot to Real Assistant

The difference between a useless chatbot and a real assistant comes down to three layers. Most people stop at the first one.

1 Prompt Engineering

How you talk to your assistant. "Write me an email" gets you garbage. "Write a follow-up email to a plumbing company owner who asked about automating their hiring process. Keep it under 100 words, casual tone, and include a link to book a call." — that gets you something you can actually send.

2 Context Engineering

What your assistant knows when it starts working. Think of a day-1 intern with no onboarding — "Here's a desk, figure it out." They'll ask you 50 questions or guess wrong. Now give that same intern your company docs, last quarter's data, and a style guide. Suddenly they're useful.

3 Intent Engineering

What your assistant wants to achieve. Goals, values, boundaries. This is the difference between "respond to emails" and "nurture warm leads toward a consultation booking while never being pushy." Each layer multiplies the one below it. Skip a layer and the whole thing collapses.

Each layer **multiplies** the one below it. Skip a layer and the whole thing collapses.

Most businesses stall at layer one — they write great prompts but give zero context. That's like giving a brilliant new hire perfect instructions but no access to your files, your clients, or your calendar. They'll do exactly what you asked, but miss everything you didn't think to say.

The magic happens when all three layers work together. That's when you go from "neat party trick" to "I can't believe I used to do all this manually."

An Agent Is Three Things

Strip away the hype and an agent is just:

A Brain

The language model —
Claude, GPT, Gemini.
This is the thinking part.

Hands

Tools it can use —
email, calendar,
databases,
spreadsheets.

A Job Description

Persona, goals, and
boundaries. The context
and rules it follows.

That's it. Everything else is **implementation details**.

The Anatomy of a Good Agent

Think of it like writing a job posting. A good agent needs six things:

Soul

Personality and values. Trustworthy advisor,
not a used car salesman.

Skills

Specific tasks it performs. Sweet spot: 7-10 per
agent. More than that and quality drops.

Context

Only the info it needs. Your CFO doesn't need
your social calendar.

Intent

What it's trying to achieve. KPIs, goals, how
success is defined.

Tools

What it can actually touch. APIs, databases,
calendars, email.

Heartbeat

When it works. Scheduled tasks, event
triggers, or always-on monitoring.

Get these six pieces right and your agent actually works. Miss one and you've got an expensive toy.

YOUR TURN

Start Here

You don't have to build the whole thing today. Start with one hat.

Today

15 minutes

Pick one repetitive task you hate
Write a detailed prompt — include context, not just instructions
Save it. Reuse it. Your future self will thank you.

This Month

A few hours

Set up a Claude or ChatGPT project with your company docs
Give it a persona and clear goals
Use it daily for one specific workflow

This Quarter

Talk to me

Build a real agent with tools and a heartbeat
One narrow agent, one clear goal
Or... that's literally what Shimmer Labs does. Let's chat.

ONE LAST THING

Your Most Valuable Skill

These tools match experienced professionals on **70-83% of knowledge work**. That sounds impressive until you realize your competitive edge lives in the **17-30% where they get it wrong**.

"The output is disposable. The rejection is the asset."

Knowing when to say "that's wrong" is the real skill. The people who thrive with these tools aren't the ones who accept every output — they're the ones who know exactly what good looks like and refuse to settle.

Let's **Work Together**

"We automate the boring stuff."

Free Consultation

Tell me what hats you're wearing. I'll tell you which ones fit on your sidecar. No pitch, just conversation. 30 minutes.

calendly.com/logan-shimmerlabs/free-consultation

Product Research Partner

I'm building automation tools for real businesses like yours. If you're curious, let's talk about what you actually need. 60 minutes.

calendly.com/logan-shimmerlabs/product-research-interview

logan@shimmerlabs.co

shimmerlabs.co

Sidecar by Shimmer Labs

Your business, but with a copilot. Coming soon.